

The Monitor

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FEATURES

F5: Paige Lawrence on Wildflowers, Vintage Furniture, a Fiddle-Leaf Fig Plant + More

Anna Zappia · Design Milk Architecture

Raised in Texas, Paige Lawrence earned a bachelor's degree from Vanderbilt University before moving to Los Angeles. It was here that an early role in kitchen design and interiors sparked her interest in the built environment.

Lawrence eventually received a graduate degree and became a licensed architect. After several years at a residential firm, she returned to the Lone Star State and joined 787 Design Studio, where she leads the practice alongside founder Patrick Mackie.

Photo: Shay Wills

The duo is known for thoughtfully-designed homes across Austin and the surrounding region that respond to the natural landscape. For Lawrence, a project always starts with the floorplan. "I thoroughly enjoy the process of getting to know a client's daily life, their routines and rituals," she says. "That understanding is everything, because it's what allows me to design spaces that don't just look beautiful, but genuinely function for the people within them."

To capture her ideas, Lawrence uses a combination of analog and tech. As a self-described doodler, Lawrence almost always grabs a sketchpad, because she loves the tactile feel of pen on paper. She is careful to not make waste with endless scraps, and if multiple iterations are needed, she can easily switch to an iPad.

While Lawrence is busy with career and family obligations, if she could find the time she would try her hand at woodworking or making furniture. "There's something really appealing to me about creating a piece you can actually use, that will sit in someone's home and last," she notes. "And honestly, the technicalities of it suit my type-A mind."

Today, Paige Lawrence joins us for Friday Five !

Photo: Paige Lawrence

1. Wildflowers

Growing up in Texas, I've always been in awe of the wildflowers that seem to appear out of nowhere each year. They're a simple surprise that never gets old and bring a quiet sense of joy. I feel a responsibility to care for and preserve them on my own property so this small, magical moment can be experienced for generations to come.

Photo: Paige Lawrence

2. Fiddle Fig

I bought this fiddle-leaf fig plant on a whim about 13 years ago when I first moved to Austin. It was barely a foot tall and picked up at a big-box hardware store, with no real plan for what would come next. Since then, it's been through three moves, countless trims, and more neglect than it probably

deserved. I've chopped it back many times and propagated smaller versions along the way. Despite my questionable plant skills, it's continued to grow and thrive. It's one of the first things people notice when they walk into our home and has become a lasting part of its identity. I'm excited to see what it becomes next.

Photo: Paige Lawrence

3. Dogs

I've always been a dog person and have never been without one. While dogs have brought me a lot of joy, they've also brought heartache. In my early 20s, living in Los Angeles, they pushed me to explore parks and hiking trails I might not have found otherwise. Now, they give our family something to care for, learn from, and gather around. They've become a quiet way to teach our children responsibility while still enjoying the companionship and love dogs bring. We recently adopted our newest dog in what felt like pure fate, and it's been one of the best decisions we've made. He's playful, affectionate, patient with kids of all ages, and a perfect fit for our family.

Photo: Paige Lawrence

4. Vintage Furniture

I've always been drawn to patterns and vintage furniture, and when the two come together, it feels like the best of both worlds. These chairs were passed down to me from a family member and won me over immediately. The bold, colorful pattern paired with the simple vintage frame creates an easy balance. They make a statement without trying too hard. That's what I love about vintage furniture, it carries character and presence without feeling pretentious or showy.

Photo: Paige Lawrence

5. Sunrises and Sunsets

This may not come as a surprise to some, as I imagine it's a favorite for many. Much like Texas wildflowers, sunrises and sunsets still catch me off guard. Even though they happen every day, their beauty never feels routine. The variety of colors and settings never gets old. A sunrise feels like a new beginning, bringing energy and hope for the day ahead, while a sunset offers a sense of peace and quiet closure. The colors they produce are some of the most magical hues nature creates, and knowing the moment is brief makes it feel special. Like being part of a quiet, shared experience with millions of others.

Works by Paige Lawrence and 787 Design Studio:

Photo: Tobin Davies

With its undulating steel railing and integrated details, this staircase reimagines structure as sculpture, where code, craft, and color converge.

Take a Closer Look at the Los Angeles Dodgers' Back-To-Back World Series Championship Ring

Hypebeast

The Los Angeles Dodgers were presented with their 2025 World Series championship rings during a pregame ceremony

The custom jewelry features 86 diamonds and 17 blue sapphires set in 14-karat yellow gold

This milestone marks the first time in the franchise's history that the team has secured back-to-back titles

The Los Angeles Dodgers have officially secured their 2025 World Series Championship rings. Celebrating a historic back-to-back title run, the MLB team unveiled the glittering physical symbols of their victory during a special pregame ceremony in front of their home crowd.

The celebration marked the first time in the franchise's storied history that the organization claimed consecutive World Series championships. The Friday night ceremony saw superstars like Shohei Ohtani, Freddie Freeman, and Mookie Betts accept their intricate new hardware. The event culminated with a special appearance from recently retired pitcher Clayton Kershaw, who returned to the mound to throw the ceremonial first pitch and receive his own ring alongside his former teammates.

The 2025 World Series Championship ring is a staggering piece of custom jewelry. Studded with an array of diamonds and sapphires, the 14-karat yellow gold ring contains a unique ring-within-a-ring feature enclosing actual dirt gathered from home plate during Game 7 against the Toronto Blue Jays. A total of 86 diamonds spell out "World Champions" across the face, while 17 blue sapphires inside the L. A. logo represent the team's total postseason wins.

Further detailing includes 79 diamonds and 48 round sapphires resting behind the primary logo, alongside an additional 70 round diamonds framing the centerpiece. The side of the ring proudly reads "Back 2 Back" in blue, while the exterior band displays the number 4,012,470—a direct tribute to the team's total attendance during the 2025 season. Every ring also features the individual player's engraved signature on the interior band.

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Springtime Pot-au-feu Beef Stew Recipe

Clotilde · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, The French Market Cookbook !

Our spring has been less than exemplary, with record low temperatures and downpours. And in a country that loves (loves!) to complain about the weather, the season has turned into a total moan fest.

I usually try to steer clear of such discussions — is there anything less constructive than griping about something no one can control? — and just nod non-committally whenever bad-weather comments are made. But in this instance, even I have to admit that boy, this May has felt a lot like a November .

And so, in order to bridge the gap between the expected season and the actual one, I decided to make a springtime pot-au-feu . It would combine the comforts of this epitomic cold-weather beef stew with the vibrancy of the first sprightly vegetables that have bravely managed to sprout and grow despite the unseemly meteorologic conditions: pencil-thin new carrots, baby fennel bulbs, green peas, and waxy little potatoes.

For a really good pot-au-feu, you need to cook the meat for a goooooo loooooong time — four hours is just about right — and you need to make it the day before you intend to serve it: this allows the flavors to deepen, and gives you a chance to skim some of the fat from the broth, making the whole dish lighter and more refined.

The classic wintry pot-au-feu typically includes leeks, carrots, turnips, celeriac, and potatoes, and sometimes cabbage, which are added to the meat as it cooks until they become very very tender. In my version, since the vegetables I wanted to feature were quick to cook, I first stewed the meat with the odds and ends I keep in the freezer for stock-making purposes, such as leek greens and fennel tops, to produce a flavorful broth in which to cook the star vegetables at the last minute.

The lovely, lovely thing about pot-au-feu is that is it meant to be served in two installments : first the broth, with fresh herbs and good crusty bread, and then the meat and vegetables, with more of the broth, strong mustard, and perky little cornichons*.

Pot-au-feu is ordinarily a dish that I would cook for company, but this time I decided to make it just for us , with good meat I had purchased through the Ruche qui dit oui! . We got three splendid dinners out of it during a very busy week when it was a blessing to have our evening meals ready to reheat in minutes. (I will also note, in case you have a young child at home, that my one-year-old took to the dish like a duck to water; this currently holds his record for most food-related enthusiasm.)

* You can even wedge in a third attraction by cooking marrow bones (one section per guest) in the broth for 30

minutes, and serving them with toasted bread after the broth and before the meat, sprinkled with fleur de sel and black pepper. Marrow bones may also be roasted in the oven at 200°C (400°F) for 25 to 30 minutes.

Have you tried this? Share your pics on Instagram!

Please tag your pictures with #cnzrecipes . I'll share my favorites!

Springtime Pot-au-feu Beef Stew Recipe

Prep Time: 20 minutes

Cook Time: 4 hours, 25 minutes

Total Time: 24 hours

Serves 6.

For the meat and broth:

1.5 kilos (3 1/3 pounds) sustainably raised beef for stewing (see note below), cut into 5-cm (2-inch) cubes

leek greens from about 3 leeks, roughly chopped

1 large carrot , sliced

8 fennel stalks or 2 celery stalks, roughly chopped

2 cloves garlic , roughly crushed

1 medium onion , roughly chopped

2 cloves

1/4 teaspoon black peppercorns , crushed with the side of the blade

1 bay leaf

1 teaspoon herbes de Provence or similar dried herb mix (basil, rosemary, oregano, savory, thyme...)

1 1/2 teaspoons fine sea salt

For the vegetables:

450 grams (1 pound) waxy new potatoes , about 10 small ones

450 grams (1 pound) small new carrots , trimmed (keep a small tuft of the stem) and halved lengthwise if on the thick side

200 grams (7 ounces) baby fennel , trimmed and halved or quartered

10 shallots , peeled and halved (leave in the root end so they will keep their shape)

350 grams (3/4 pound, about 2 1/2 cups) shelled green peas

Light, Space, and Proportion Coalesce in the Conrad Residence

Joseph Sgambati III · Design Milk Architecture

Architecture often reveals itself most clearly when stripped back to its essentials. Space, light, proportion, and material—these enduring elements have shaped the discipline for centuries, yet they are rarely expressed with such quiet clarity as in the Conrad Residence in Malvern, a leafy suburb in Melbourne’s inner east. Designed by architect Paul Conrad of Paul Conrad Architects for himself, his wife, and their two children, the home operates as both a family dwelling and a distilled manifesto of the studio’s design philosophy.

The project began with patience. Conrad spent two years searching for a site that could capture the garden character of the neighborhood while offering northern orientation—an important condition in Australian architecture for maximizing natural light. The opportunity finally appeared during Melbourne’s extended COVID lockdowns, when the property was purchased through a Zoom auction and the design process quietly commenced.

From the outset, Conrad approached the house differently than many contemporary residential projects. Rather than allowing the façade or external form to drive the design, the project began with what he describes as “interior architecture”—the careful orchestration of spatial relationships, proportions, and views between rooms. In Conrad’s practice, this internal structure forms the connective tissue between architecture and interior design, determining how spaces feel, how light moves through them, and how occupants experience the home over time.

That internal logic ultimately shapes the home’s outward presence. From the street, the residence presents a restrained and almost reticent façade. Covered in Boston Ivy, the structure reveals little of itself beyond a limestone-clad portal framing a dark-stained oak door. The gesture is deliberate: an architectural quietness that allows the house to settle naturally into its established suburban context while hinting at classical proportion beneath its contemporary expression.

Inside, the architecture unfolds as a carefully balanced sequence of spaces—formal and intimate at the front of the home, more open and contemporary toward the rear. Conrad describes the aesthetic as one of deliberate contradictions: minimal yet rich, restrained yet bold, poised yet relaxed.

These tensions are expressed through spatial transitions. A study near the entry adopts a more classical sensibility, with tall steel-framed French doors emphasizing vertical proportion and symmetry. Part library and part gallery, the room functions as a creative retreat where Conrad develops his architectural work. Further into the house, the primary living, dining, and kitchen areas expand into a more fluid environment defined by floor-to-ceiling aluminum sliding doors that open toward the garden and northern sun. Here, architecture dissolves into landscape, with an oversized

marble kitchen bench and custom brass pendant acting as sculptural anchors within the space.

The home’s material palette reinforces the same philosophy of restraint paired with richness. Limestone, Calacatta Paonazzo marble, aged brass, linen, silver leaf, and textured European oak form a tightly controlled vocabulary that appears throughout the house. Rather than polished perfection, the materials are chosen for their ability to age gracefully—limestone brushed to reveal its grain, oak floorboards hand-scraped and laid in varying widths, steel handrails beaten and blackened to emphasize their handcrafted origins. Over time, Conrad expects these surfaces to accumulate patina, allowing everyday family life to become part of the architecture itself.

Light, meanwhile, becomes one of the home’s most expressive materials. A sculptural stair beneath an elliptical skylight draws daylight deep into the interior, while expansive glazing toward the garden blurs the boundary between inside and outside. Artificial lighting is equally deliberate, with adjustable LED systems calibrated room by room. In the gym, color temperature shifts from warm tones for yoga and meditation to cooler daylight for more energetic workouts; in the bedrooms, lighting subtly follows the rhythms of the day, echoing the natural cycle of the sun.

Programmatically, the residence unfolds across three levels. The ground floor holds the primary living spaces alongside Conrad’s study and a children’s art and study room. Four bedrooms and Katrina Conrad’s study occupy the upper floor, while the basement accommodates a gym, playroom, wine cellar, and parking. Landscape architect Paul Bangay designed the garden, where lawn, pool, and plantings extend the home’s spatial composition outward into the site.

Designing one’s own home presents its own set of challenges. While Conrad’s studio frequently works on expansive luxury estates, this inner-city block came with tighter spatial and budgetary constraints. The project was developed largely after hours, evolving slowly between professional commissions over a year of design and eighteen months of construction. Yet Conrad notes that working for himself also simplified the process: the brief was already instinctively understood.

Ultimately, the Conrad Residence reads less as a showpiece and more as a quiet architectural essay—an exploration of the enduring qualities that continue to define the discipline. Space, light, and proportion guide the experience, while materials deepen with time. The result is a home that does not attempt to shout its presence, but instead settles confidently into its surroundings, embodying the timeless ambition of architecture itself.

To explore more works by the designer’s eponymous firm, visit paulconradarchitects.com.

Photography courtesy of Timothy Kaye.

Be a Smart Traveler

Anne Gordon · Live Life Travel

Be a SMART Traveler

WRITTEN BY ANNE GORDON, OWNER, LEISURE TRAVEL ADVISOR,

LIVE LIFE TRAVEL • WWW.LIVELIFETRAVEL.WORLD

Here are some essentials to becoming a SMART Traveler:

STEP (SMART TRAVELER ENROLLMENT PROGRAM):

Register all International Travel with STEP. This ensures that the local US Embassy can contact and locate you in case of an emergency while traveling: <https://step.state.gov/step/>

IMPORTANT TRAVEL DOCUMENTATION:

REAL ID: Deadline is 10/1/20 <https://www.tsa.gov/real-id>

GLOBAL ENTRY: <https://www.cbp.gov/travel/trusted-traveler-programs/global-entry>

CLEAR: <https://www.clearme.com/>

VISA : Some countries require a visa to enter them, you should apply as early as possible as some are harder to obtain than others. <https://cibtvisas.com/visa-quick-check>

Avoid lines by having the proper documentation

PLAN AHEAD:

Learn about your destination before you get there and arrive well-informed – We recommend the State Department as a trusted resource: <https://travel.state.gov/content/passports/en/country.html>

STAY HEALTHY:

Use one trusted source for all travel-related health information, including vaccines you may need: <https://www.nc.cdc.gov/travel>

Other tips: Wash your hands often, travel with hand sanitizer and wipes, pack more than enough of your prescription medication (you may want to carry an extra scrip on you as well), get your annual flu vaccine, drink bottled water/stay hydrated.

FINANCIAL SMARTS:

Avoid international fees by using a travel credit card that waives them.

Get a duplicate of your ATM card to travel with.

Take out foreign currency once in destination using a bank ATM, avoid airport currency exchanges and never take out a cash advance on your credit card.

Carry emergency fund cash on you at all times.

Leave all of your valuables at home (including the engagement rings).

Common Sense: The best advice that we could give any traveler today is to use plain old common sense. Be smart, be aware of your surroundings at all times and be prepared. Lock all doors and don't go out alone at night (even on the beach).

PLAN AHEAD:

Get your passport renewed at least one year before it expires (reminder that kids passports only last for 5 years; adults for 10): <https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/passports/havepassport/renew.html>

Leave your passports locked in your hotel safe; carry a copy on your person while in destination (we travel with both paper copies and have them backed up in the cloud on our mobile devices).

Make sure your travel advisor has copies of your updated passports pre-travel (do not email or text any ID or credit card info).

Use RFID blocking and never store your passport in a carry on or check it with other luggage.

A FEW FINAL TIPS TO KEEP YOU HEALTHY DURING AIR TRAVEL:

A certain celebrity always travels with Neosporin and uses a Q-Tip to apply it gently in their nostrils before every flight (we are seriously going to try this!)

I personally take and travel with Airborne (chewable tablets) and swear by them (pre, during and post air travel.)

Beware of the water on planes, we recommend washing your hands with soap and water and then always using your hand sanitizer upon return to your seat.

With all of this said, please don't be afraid to travel, just be smart when you do. These same "essential tips" can also be applied to your everyday life.

The post Be a Smart Traveler appeared first on Live Life Travel .

Air Fryer Chicken Thighs

Lindsay · Pinch of Yum

These Chicken Thighs Are a New House Favorite!

Guys, I've been holding myself back from making these chicken thighs every single night. They're so good. They go with almost anything, they're extra juicy and crisped, and the kids and adults in my family BOTH approve!

I love them with so many things:

roasted potato wedges and a cucumber salad

a creamy pasta

a wrap, sandwich, or salad

a baked potato and some roasted veggies

just eating straight with a side of your favorite sauce! (all my favorite sauces here !)

The chicken is so so flavor-crusted and so finger-licking yummy that I still can hardly believe you can make it in the air fryer.

I have to fight my kids not to eat it all off the cutting board before it even makes it to the table.

If you've made our air fryer chicken breasts (also amazing), the flavor on these chicken thighs is more savory. The OG chicken breast recipe has a brown sugar and smoked paprika base, whereas this one has paprika, garlic and onion, and a bit of oregano.

I have been LOVING these with a smoky paprika aioli (I'll include that in the recipe notes – it is so yummy). I am making myself hungry just thinking about it.

Hope you guys love it!

How To Make Air Fryer Chicken Thighs

1

Trim Chicken Thighs.

Optional, but I often cut off any little bits of fat that are on the edges of the chicken thighs.

2

Toss with Spices!

Get those chicken thighs totally coated! Like so.

3

Air Fry for 11-13 Minutes.

Place in a single layer in the air fryer to cook evenly!

4

It's done!

Do a quick temp check – the inside should reach a minimum of 165 degrees (I use this meat thermometer to check).

5

Cut and Serve!

My daughter and my husband couldn't wait for me to finish the photos. ☺ I like to chop the chicken into bite-sized pieces and squeeze a bit of lemon over the whole thing! So yummy.

5 Stars 4 Stars 3 Stars 2 Stars 1 Star

5 from 15 reviews

Author: Lindsay

Total Time: 28 minutes

Yield: 4 servings 1 x

These air fryer chicken thighs are SO good. Super juicy, deeply golden, and ready in 15 minutes! Such an easy recipe that my whole family loves.

1.25 pounds boneless skinless chicken thighs

1 1/2 teaspoons paprika

1 teaspoon oregano

1/2 teaspoon garlic powder

1/2 teaspoon onion powder

3/4 teaspoon salt (I've been using a fine-grained table salt for this)

a few cracks of freshly ground black pepper

1 tablespoon olive oil

squeeze of lemon to finish

Cook Mode

Prevent your screen from going dark

Trim the Chicken Thighs: Optional, but I usually cut off the little bits of fat (the chunkier white strips) from the edges of the chicken thighs.

Season the Chicken: Toss the chicken thighs with the spices and olive oil. For the best flavor, let it marinate anywhere from 15 minutes to 2-3 hours in the fridge. (Also fine to skip if you're short on time!)

Air Fry Chicken: Air fry at 375 for 11-13 minutes, until deeply golden and a bit crisped on the outside, and at least 165 degrees Fahrenheit on the inside. (I use a meat

Weekend reading: National scandal

The Investor · Monevator

What caught my eye this week.

Considering the high hurdle that politicians and business leaders have set themselves for something to be considered a sacking offence, I was surprised to see the boss of National Savings & Investments (NS&I) resign this week.

Of course, the NS&I FUBAR was a rough experience for the 37,500 people affected. NS&I's mistakes saw bereaved families facing delays accessing their relatives' Premium Bonds with a total value of up to £476m.

To give just one example from a BBC report :

Tracy McGuire-Brown from Newbury in Berkshire [...] took six years to claim £2,000 in premium bonds her late father had left in his will.

The 61-year-old former care home manager says she "cannot describe how upsetting and frustrating" it was to deal with NS&I, and that she had to send in her father's will and other original documents at her own expense.

"It was the most awful, awful experience," she says.

No doubt – and not what anyone wants to deal with in the wake of the death of a loved one.

However, NS&I has more than 24 million customers holding £240bn with the institution, so the number affected is relatively small. According to Which the problems were caused by administrative failures – bad, certainly, but not malicious. The long delay between problems emerging and NS&I coming clean is problematic, but again the scale of the operation mitigates this to some extent.

With all that said – and, again, not to make light of having to fight to get your own money back – I think the real reason boss Dax Harkins had to go was because NS&I is held to a higher standard than a typical High Street bank, on the basis of its 100% government backing.

Trust buster

I've often recommended NS&I savings or Premium Bonds to fretful – but essentially financially uninterested – friends and relatives looking for somewhere safe to put their cash. Especially after the financial crisis.

No worries about bank runs with NS&I, or Financial Services Compensation Scheme limits, or your savings somehow getting muddled up in riskier lending. Just okay interest rates, the infinitesimal chance to win big with ERNIE, and a recommendation made in the same vein as nobody getting fired for buying IBM.

Also, faith in NS&I's systems underwrites the Premium Bond draw.

There are already conspiracies about which Bonds win and who gets what prizes. NS&I can do without incompetence creeping into the mix, too.

Further reading:

A terse apology from National Savings & Investments – NS&I

NS&I boss replaced as savers left waiting for millions of pounds – BBC

What caused the missing NS&I savings, and what you should do – Guardian

Another take on the scandal and next steps if you're affected – Which

NS&I will have to pay compensation in some cases, say ministers – This Is Money

Have a great weekend.

Commodities are working – Monevator

The natural yield model portfolio wheels are turning – Monevator [Members]

From the archive-ator: A plan to be financially independent in ten years – Monevator

World faces 'stark and deep recession', says BlackRock boss – This Is Money

Temporary petrol shortages possible at some pumps, warns ASDA – Guardian

How Trump and the oil price move in sync [Charts] – BBC

Reminder: the state pension age rises in April – Which

Buying UK housing most affordable since 2015 on price-to-earnings basis... – ONS

...as London house prices drop again... – City AM

...but rents are at an all-time high relative to incomes – Sky

Final candidates for seven new towns named – BBC

SpaceX's mooted IPO valuation is in another orbit – Sherwood

Government defends landlord tax hikes as 'fairer' system – Property 118

FCA launches later life mortgage [a.k.a. equity release] study – Mortgage Strategy

Who ate all China's stock market returns? [Paywall] – FT

Products and services

(Edited for length)

How to Create Your Own Lightroom Presets (Step By Step)

Andrew S. Gibson · Digital Photography School

The post [How to Create Your Own Lightroom Presets \(Step By Step\)](#) appeared first on Digital Photography School . It was authored by Andrew S. Gibson .

How can you create and save presets in Lightroom?

In this article, I'm going to take you through the simple process, step by step. By the time you're done, you'll be able to confidently make presets of your own – and I'll even show you how to make and apply import presets for high-quality, lightning-fast edits.

Let's dive right in.

When should you create and apply Lightroom presets?

There are mundane edits in Lightroom that you should carry out on almost every photo.

And you can save time by creating presets that perform these jobs automatically upon import. That way, you don't have to do editing later.

In other words: I highly recommend you apply presets to pretty much every photo you take.

(You can also apply presets during the editing process, but you'll want to use these more sparingly.)

The fact is that RAW photos need edits to look good. And presets will help you do those edits faster than a standard editing workflow. Look at this unedited RAW file:

A straight-out-of-camera RAW file from an EOS 5D Mark II. This is the sort of image you'll see when you import images into Lightroom without applying a Develop preset.

And look at it after applying a simple preset:

The same photo, but with the Profile set to Landscape , lens corrections applied, chromatic aberrations removed, and white balance set to Auto . This is what you would see after importing the photo into Lightroom if you applied an import preset similar to the one I show you how to make in this article. The biggest benefit is that it saves you time.

That's what I'm going to teach you how to do in the next section:

Create a simple preset that you can apply upon importing. But note that you can use these instructions to create a preset of any type, whether you plan to apply it on import or not.

How to prepare a useful Lightroom preset: step by step

Now let's take a look at the simple instructions for making a useful Lightroom preset:

Step 1: Open a photo in the Develop module

Start by selecting the photo you plan to use as your preset base. Open it in the Lightroom Develop module.

Hit the Reset button to zero out any existing settings:

(You may find it helpful to make a Virtual Copy of the photo first so you don't undo any edits you have already made; you can do this by right-clicking on the image, then selecting Create Virtual Copy .)

Step 2: Set your Profile in the Basic panel

Next, you'll need to pick a Profile . Think of this as a starting point or base layer, on top of which you'll make all your edits.

So head up to the Basic panel and click to open the Profile fly-out menu:

Lightroom's default Profile is Adobe Color , and this is where I often leave my photos – but if you're a frequent landscape photographer, you might try Adobe Landscape , portrait photographers might try Adobe Portrait , and black and white photographers might try Adobe Monochrome . Really, it's all about experimenting. Test out a few options and see what you like!

Remember that, even if you save a profile as part of a preset, you can always change it after applying the preset if you decide it doesn't work for a particular shot.

(Also, note that your Profile options may vary depending on your camera, so if you can't find one of the options I suggested, don't worry; you probably have other cool Profiles to try out instead.)

If you shoot a number of different genres or in a number of different styles, or if you simply like several profiles, you might consider creating a preset for each one!

Step 3: Apply profile corrections and remove chromatic aberration

Most shots suffer from slight issues due to lens aberrations. The specifics depend on your lens, which is why Lightroom comes with profiles for a huge number of lenses:

Just a few of the many lens profiles included in Lightroom.

So head down to the Lens Corrections panel and check Enable Profile Corrections :

If Lightroom offers a profile matching your lens's make and model – and it almost certainly will! – the profile corrections will be applied automatically.

I'd also recommend checking Remove Chromatic Aberration , which will get rid of fringing (which you pretty much always want to do!).

Chocolate Buckwheat Pound Cake Recipe

clotilde · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, *The French Market Cookbook* !

I love pound cakes, or quatre-quarts * in French. As a child, I went through a phase of eating Breton pound cake for breakfast day in, day out. I'm talking about supermarket pound cake, baked in long yellow logs and wrapped in soft paper. I liked it on the stale side, so I sliced it in advance, and let it age three to four days. I was an affineur of pound cake if you will.

I only recently discovered the beauty of homemade pound cake , and it has become one of my could-make-it-blind-folded cakes, in rotation with my French yogurt cake .

You know how pound cakes work , right ? You weigh the eggs, and add the same weight in sugar, melted butter, and flour. This means these ingredients each form a quarter of the batter, hence the French name, four-quarters. The English name comes from originally using a pound each of the ingredients, but that yields a pretty big cake. The French ratio allows for more flexibility.

Of course, it doesn't tell you if you're supposed to weigh the eggs with or without the shell, and how much baking powder to add. In truth, you can just relax about both. We're not building a rocket ship; we're baking a cake. Weigh the eggs with or without, add one or two teaspoons of baking powder, it will be fine. Channel your inner French grandma and do what feels right.

And it is a recipe that lends itself to variations with remarkable grace; my favorite kind of recipe for sure. Today I will share one of my favorite riffs: the buckwheat and chocolat pound cake .

I've been enjoying the buckwheat and chocolate pairing for years, by ordering a chocolate buckwheat crêpe for dessert at crêperies (Brittany again!). It is divine. Almost better than sugar-and-butter. Try and tell me what you think.

In this spirit, I make a pound cake with 100% buckwheat flour (this makes it gluten-free) and fold a generous amount of chocolate chips (or chopped chocolate) into the batter. The result is deeply flavorful, fluffy and moist, with chocolate in every bite, and a lovely crust dotted with sugar, my signature touch.

For the maths majors out there , let me confess two things: this becomes, in effect, a five-fifths (cinq-cinquièmes) rather than a four-fourths, just like my pistachio pound cake . And because I prefer my cakes not too sweet, I decrease the amount of sugar a little bit, which admittedly throws off the ratio, but who's counting?

You will also notice that I give you the option of using coconut butter here, a magical ingredient I told you about here and here . In baking, it can replace regular butter,

and here the coconut note is hardly noticeable against the buckwheat and chocolate.

It is a cake that is quick and simple to prepare, and because the formula is easy to memorize, it's a great cake to bake on vacation with no cookbook and no Internet connection, to impress your friends as the baking fairy (or wizard) you really are. A skill that happens to be on my bucket list for cooks .

* I'll let you get away with pronouncing this cat-car .

Have you tried this? Share your pics on Instagram!

Please tag your pictures with #cnzrecipes . I'll share my favorites!

Chocolate Buckwheat Pound Cake Recipe

Prep Time: 20 minutes

Cook Time: 25 minutes

Total Time: 1 hour

Serves 6.

3 large eggs (see note)

2/3 cup (130 grams) raw cane sugar , plus extra for sprinkling (see note)

6 ounces (170 grams) coconut butter , heated and stirred to a smooth consistency, or unsalted butter, melted and cooled

1 1/3 cups (170 grams) buckwheat flour (gluten-free-certified as needed)

2 teaspoons baking powder (gluten-free-certified as needed)

1/4 teaspoon fine sea salt

6 ounces (170 grams) good-quality dark chocolate chips (or chopped dark chocolate)

Preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a loaf pan with parchment paper (my pan is 10 by 3 1/2 inches, or 26 x 9 cm; a standard 9-by-5-inch loaf pan can be used).

In a medium bowl, whisk together the eggs, sugar, and coconut butter until slightly frothy.

In another medium bowl, combine the flour, baking powder, salt, and chocolate.

Fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients using a spatula, until no trace of flour remains.

Pour into the pan, sprinkle the top with sugar, and bake for 25 to 30 minutes, until the cake is golden brown and a knife inserted in the center comes out clean (melted chocolate is normal; it's uncooked batter you don't want to see)

A Layered Modern Farmhouse Takes Shape in North Vancouver

Leo Lei · Design Milk Architecture

Two neighboring lots in North Vancouver, British Columbia, were combined into a single ground plane where a main residence, a pool house, and a greenhouse sit not as standalone buildings but as moments within one continuous landscape. Designed by Garret Cord Werner Architects with interiors by HB Design, landscape by Donohoe Living Landscapes, and built by Meister Construction, the project treats architecture, interiors, and terrain as a single continuous material argument – one where no element claims hierarchy over the others and every threshold between inside and outside is deliberately blurred.

Roughly 6,100 square feet of built space splits between a three-level main house at 4,235 square feet and a 1,870-square-foot pool house. No corridor or breezeway connects them – only an alley that the landscape plan transforms into a true threshold. When the interior gates open, a view corridor cuts cleanly through both properties toward the North Shore mountains. The greenhouse and vegetable planters face the public lane, while boulevard plantings extend beyond the property line, softening the transition between private residence and neighborhood street.

For Ryan Donohoe, founder of Donohoe Living Landscapes, that gesture was intentional. “I’m quite opposed to landscapes that completely block out the neighbors,” he says. “Treating the laneway as part of the design allowed the landscape and its functionality to anchor into the local community rather than shutting it out.” Instead of a conventional fence line, the team developed a layered system of clipped hedging and sculptural metal screening that modulates privacy while guiding views through the site.

Materially, the garden mirrors the architecture’s restrained palette. Basalt paving and concrete define the pool deck, red cedar fencing adds warmth, and powder-coated steel forms pergolas, gates, and fire elements. A metallic bronze finish ties these elements together. “It’s a bit of a chameleon,” Donohoe notes. “From some angles it reads almost black, while from others it shifts toward a light brown that harmonizes with the brick and greenery.”

Planting reinforces the sense of a landscape still unfolding. Native species dominate much of the site, while the pool garden introduces a layered composition of Japanese maples, tassel ferns, forest grass, smoke bush, and switch grasses. Over time, these plantings will thicken into a lush envelope around the architecture. “The hardscape is extremely precise,” Donohoe says, “but the softscape is designed to grow into itself, creating layers that cool the ground and bring a sense of calm away from the busyness of modern living.”

The modern farmhouse vocabulary of brick, wood slat, and expansive glazing finds its counterpoint in HB Design’s interior strategy. Partner Shannon Bradner led the interiors alongside principal Jennifer Heffel, joining the project at

an advanced stage yet delivering a remarkably coordinated drawing package.

“The architecture already had a strong presence,” Bradner explains, “so our goal was to soften that rigor through layers of natural materials and subtle tonal shifts.” The palette remains neutral and earthy, drawn from the surrounding North Shore landscape, but the interiors reveal themselves through texture rather than color alone. Porcelain tile, quartzite, and carefully selected woods were chosen for how they capture and shift light throughout the day while complementing the brick exterior.

The sourcing process stretched across several months, calibrating undertone and grain so that materials feel timeless rather than trend-driven. Custom millwork integrates storage directly into the architecture, minimizing visual clutter while highlighting natural surfaces.

The three-level main house organizes family life across an open-plan ground floor with bedrooms above, while the basement introduces a guest suite for visiting family and friends. Across the alley, the pool house acts as a social hub, its sliding glass doors opening onto a sunken lounge and pool deck. A gym, spa, and private office occupy quieter corners of the structure.

For Meister Construction, maintaining the clarity of the design intent was central to the build. “Our objective was to protect the design vision while delivering a home that feels calm, coherent, and enduring,” says owner Gordon Gildemeister. Close coordination between consultants and trades allowed details to be resolved through mockups and sequencing rather than on-site improvisation.

Durability also guided many decisions. Natural materials were selected not only for their character but for how they weather over time in the Pacific Northwest climate. “Assemblies need to manage water and movement properly,” Gildemeister explains. “Our goal is a house that performs reliably and becomes easier – not harder – to own over time.”

Seen together, the architecture, interiors, and landscape resolve into a quiet thesis on West Coast living – one that privileges light, durability, and a generous relationship to the outdoors. Or, as Donohoe puts it: “modern living set into a West Coast vernacular where outdoor life matters just as much as what happens inside.”

View more information on HB Design’s website .

Chipotle Cumin Roasted Almonds Recipe

clotilde · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, The French Market Cookbook !

I am ordinarily immune to the pre-holiday rush everyone talks about. I am not in charge of cooking an elaborate Christmas meal (I contribute but don't host), I don't attend a trillion holiday functions, and we don't go crazy with the presents in my family, so the lead-up to the holidays isn't significantly busier than other times of the year.

For some reason though, the end of this year has felt particularly intense . Not with holiday-related stuff, but with various work projects I was striving to complete before taking a little time off to cuddle up at the foot of the Christmas tree and sip hot cocoa while humming Petit Papa Noël (you're welcome).

Of course, when you're a freelancer, having a lot of work is something to rejoice — not complain — about, but what it means is that I have had zero time to get my act together and prepare edible gifts as I aspire to.

Fortunately I have a few tricks up my sleeve, and just a couple of days ago I decided I was going to be giving little bags of the chipotle cumin roasted almonds I've been making for myself (and love love loving) lately.

They are a great example of something simple and easy that is still absolutely lovely to receive: few people actually take the time to make their own spiced and roasted nuts, yet they are so much tastier homemade than store-bought. They disappear in an instant when you offer them with a pre-dinner cocktail, and I also love to nibble on them in the afternoon, or chop them coarsely and add them to my lunch salads.

So if you're sitting here wondering whether there's still time to whip something up before the gift-giving commences, chances are there is: all you need is a handful of pantry ingredients and half an hour.

And if you want more edible gift ideas , here is a selection from the Chocolate & Zucchini archives:

A pretty jar of Easy Candied Nuts , which you can then coat with chocolate as per this recipe ,

A batch of Christmas Sablés using your favorite cookie cutters,

A nice bag of Homemade Granola or Savory Granola ,

A jar of Lightly Salted Crunchy Almond Butter .

– A batch of Almond and Orange Blossom Croquants ,

– A box of Ginger and Almond Chocolate Clusters ,

– Some Spiced Chocolate Peanut Butter using your very own mix of spices,

– The ever-delicious Yves Camdeborde's Sablés (these are what I made and gave away last year).

Join the conversation!

Have your pre-holiday weeks been crazy or cozy? And are you on top of your game with edible presents this year? What's your favorite last-minute food gift to make?

Happy Holidays!

Have you tried this? Share your pics on Instagram!

Please tag your pictures with #cnzrecipes . I'll share my favorites!

Chipotle Cumin Roasted Almonds Recipe

Prep Time: 5 minutes

Cook Time: 15 minutes

Total Time: 20 minutes

Makes 4 cups; enough for 3 food gift recipients.

500 grams (4 cups) whole unblanched almonds , preferably organic

2 tablespoons olive oil

2 teaspoons fine sea salt

1 to 2 teaspoons ground chipotle , depending on how hot you want them (I buy it at L'Épicerie de Bruno ; you can substitute smoked paprika , preferably hot, or any other mild, ground chili)

2 teaspoons ground cumin

Preheat the oven to 180°C (360°F).

Place the almonds on a rimmed baking sheet. Drizzle with the olive oil (it helps the seasoning to adhere and the almonds to roast evenly), and add the salt, chipotle, and cumin. Stir until evenly coated; I find it's easiest to do this with your (clean) hands. Taste one almond and adjust the seasoning. Spread the almonds out in a single layer and insert the baking sheet into the oven.

Bake for 15 to 20 minutes, keeping an eye on them and stirring halfway through, until the almonds are nicely browned and fragrant.

Let cool completely before serving or dividing among three gift bags. The almonds will keep for a few weeks in an airtight bag or container.

If there is cumin chipotle salt left at the bottom of the baking sheet, collect and keep it for seasoning avocados.

Akari Brings Authenticity to New York's Washed Sauna Scene

Adrian Madlener · Design Milk Architecture

There are strong links between Japan and the Nordic region (a grouping of countries that includes much more than just Scandinavia). That's especially true when it comes to sauna culture. Though the word is Finnish, translating as bathhouse, the concept of pumping steam through enclosures firmly roots in Neolithic Greenland and Newfoundland. It's been an integral part of daily life across these, especially frigid, Northern reaches for eons.

In Japan, sentō and onsen facilities have been around since the 1200s. While the former is generally defined as a communal bathhouse, the latter is specified as geothermal hot springs that are encircled by traditional inns.

Gaining popularity as an alternative, far less harmful, type of third place, saunas and other types of bathhouses have cropped up across bustling metropolises like London and New York. While many tout unique amenities—some more gimmicky than others—few of these highly publicized venues hold true to the Japanese traditions mentioned before.

Cue Akari , two immersive saunas in Williamsburg and Greenpoint, Brooklyn that are as comprehensive as they are unassuming. There's no need for flashy light shows or poolside DJ-sets at these quaint, smartly outfitted wellness spaces. Comprising dry saunas, cold plunges, and quiet relaxation areas, both membership—non reservation—based venues champion the idea that New Yorkers should slow down more often and go to the bathhouse in order to reset rather than party. While the entirely renovated Williamsburg location features an incredibly rare outdoor cold plunge pool, the Greenpoint one was imagined in partnership with celebrated thermal consultant Kiel Moe .

International architecture firm Stroop Design staged the latter with intentional detailing. The aim was not to overpower the restorative act of saunaing with bold finishes or sculptural elements but to succinctly facilitate the experience with a consistent design vocabulary. Many of these accents—2 by 2 inch light green tiles—harken back to traditional sentōs. Tabletops laminated in washi paper by master craftsperson Hanato Watar were repurposed as wall art throughout.

Sparingly placed furnishings and fixtures are modestly modern, solidly made but light, reflecting the brand's name Akari, which translates as light in Japanese. The idea here is to make saunaing a daily ritual—one that has both physical and mental benefits—and remove any of the social expectation or architectural fanfare that might make it feel like a chore.

To learn more about the creative synergy between Akari Sauna and Stroop Design, visit akarisauna.com and stroop.design .

While the former is generally defined as a communal bathhouse, the latter is specified as geothermal hot springs that are encircled by traditional inns.

Adrian Madlener

Red Gomashio

Heidi Swanson · 101 Cookbooks

Gomashio is a simple Japanese seasoning made from toasted sesame seeds and salt. It adds crunch, nuttiness, and added nutrients from the sesame seeds. A few years ago I started making a red version and it quickly became a kitchen staple. Dense with sesame, dynamic with chile powder and smoked paprika, the wildcard ingredient is green cardamom. Fragrant cardamom seeds are ground with mortar and pestle along with some of the sesame and the resulting blend of spices really sings – especially when it hits something hot. And while not at all traditional, you can use it in many of the same ways you might use a more traditional version of goma (sesame) shio (salt).

Red Gomashio: Ingredients

Cardamom : Your cardamom seeds should be fragrant when crushed. You can buy cardamom in different forms – whole cardamom pods, cardamom seeds, ground cardamom seeds. For this recipe you want to start with pods or whole seeds. If you buy the seeds, it's a bit of a shortcut and you can simply pounds them in a mortar and pestle, or grind them in a clean pepper grinder. If you start with seeds you'll need about 1/4 teaspoon for this recipe.

My friend Wendy gifted me a few beautiful glass jars of spices last week (her calligraphy!), and looking at the cardamom I took it as a sign to make a fresh round of red gomashio.

Sesame Seeds : I typically keep unhulled sesame seeds on hand, and that's what I use here. Fresher is better. You want to keep sesame seeds in an airtight container, out of direct light, preferably refrigerated if you don't go through them quickly.

Onion : I prefer to use dried onion flakes here, but they can be tricky to find. Onion powder does the job as well, and is available in most stores. That said, if you plan ahead, one of my favorite ingredient discoveries lately is the toasted onion powder from Burlap & Barrel (not sponsored, just a fan). It's good in place of the dried onion flakes here.

Salt : I like to use flaky sea salt here, you can kind of crush it with your fingers into small, irregular shapes that are nice. Alternately, pink Himalayan sea salt pounded a bit with a mortar and pestle is a nice alternative.

Chile powder : I like to use Kashmiri chile powder here. It has a vibrant spiciness, fruity notes, and for the electric color (!) it brings. If you want to use another chile powder, add it gradually as your final ingredient, adding more until the overall blend is to your liking.

How To Use Red Gomashio

This is a wildly adaptable seasoning. I love it sprinkled over labneh and drizzled with a finishing extra virgin olive oil. It's good sprinkled over homemade pasta tossed with

a generous amount of butter or olive oil, some Parmesan, and whatever fresh herbs you have on hand. It's A-plus on a baked potato (or mashed potatoes omg). Or sprinkled across a plate of hard-boiled eggs . Basically it's an easy way to make everyday staples a bit special. You see it sprinkled above on onigirazu, it's equally at home on rice bowls, onigiri, and soba bowls. I also love to sprinkle it all over guacamole before serving. I could go on and on, basically keep it on your counter and use it constantly.

Here are a few process shots and visual cues in case you need them.

Grind the cardamom : This is the texture you're after when grinding the cardamom seeds. A bit of texture along with a fine grind. It's the grind I go for when grinding black pepper.

Grind some of the sesame seeds : If you have a suribachi , this would be the time to use it – I bought this one by Colleen Hennessey for Permanent Collection years ago and it's one of my prized kitchen possessions. But a mortar and pestle works nicely as well (pictured). Then you add the rest of ingredients.

Add the rest of the toasted sesame seeds : Stir in the rest of the seeds and then adjust the seasoning to your liking with more chile powder, brown sugar, salt, etc. Keep it on your counter and sprinkle with enthusiasm!

Za'atar

Continue reading Red Gomashio on 101 Cookbooks

How To Use Red Gomashio This is a wildly adaptable seasoning.

Heidi Swanson

How to Use Camera Memory Cards: 18 Essential Tips

Darren Rowse · Digital Photography School

The post How to Use Camera Memory Cards: 18 Essential Tips appeared first on Digital Photography School . It was authored by Darren Rowse .

Memory cards are an essential part of digital photography. They record your precious files and keep them safe until you're able to transfer them to your (hopefully) full-fledged storage solution – which means that it's essential that you understand how to use memory cards correctly.

After all, a properly cared-for memory card will often perform flawlessly for years – while a poorly looked-after card will be prone to errors, corruption, and loss of files.

In this article, I share 18 tips for keeping your memory cards in good condition. I explain how you should correctly eject your cards, how often (and when) you should format your cards, and more.

Let's dive right in!

1. Carry backup cards whenever you shoot

Card failure is unpredictable, and the last thing you want is to miss a once-in-a-lifetime shot because your only card decided to act up.

Therefore, I've made it a habit to carry at least three cards with me on every shoot. And while it might seem excessive, it's better to be safe than sorry!

Imagine you're capturing a breathtaking sunset or a candid moment at a child's birthday party. Suddenly, your camera stops working due to a card error. If you have a backup, you just switch cards and continue shooting. But without a backup, that moment is lost forever. (Of course, it's not just about having extras; it's also about ensuring you have enough storage to keep shooting without worries.)

For different shoots, the backup cards you choose can vary. For a casual day out, a couple of smaller capacity cards might suffice. But for a professional gig, you might want to carry a handful of larger, high-speed cards. These backups will be your photography lifeline .

By the way, one thing I've noticed that's true, at least for myself: having backup cards provides immense peace of mind. When you're focused on getting the perfect shot, the last thing you want is to worry about storage space or card failure. The backups serve as a guarantee that no matter what happens, your photography can go on uninterrupted.

2. If disaster strikes, stop shooting

If you're in the middle of a photoshoot and you run into a memory card problem – for instance, you accidentally delete your images or see a card error message – then stop photographing immediately .

Turn off your camera, eject the card, and store it in a safe place. When you run into one of these problems, all is not lost, and you may still be able to recover the images. However, it's important that you stop using the card; otherwise, you might overwrite the files. Data recovery services and other tools are often very effective, especially when recovering accidentally deleted files , but once an image is overwritten, then it's often lost forever.

If you do have a memory card issue while shooting, you can always continue the session with another card. The key is to safely remove the problematic card as soon as possible.

3. Treat your cards well

It's crucial to treat your memory cards with care, especially when you're out in difficult conditions. In the heat of the moment, switching cards quickly might seem necessary, but it's also essential to take the time to handle them properly. I've seen too many instances where a little negligence led to big problems. A few tips here:

First, always ensure your hands are clean when handling memory cards. Dirt and oils don't mesh well with the delicate connectors. And hold the cards gently by the edges, avoiding the gold contacts. This might sound like overkill, but it's these small habits that can prolong the life of your cards.

Another key point is to be focused when handling your cards. Distractions can lead to accidental drops, especially in outdoor environments. I've heard of photographers dropping cards into puddles. Don't let that be you!

Proper storage is also vital. When not in use, keep your cards in a protective case to shield them from dust, moisture, and physical damage. Avoid extreme temperatures and magnetic sources as these can damage the data. Think of your memory cards as fragile; that way, you'll have the best shot at preserving the images they hold.

4. Avoid deleting files one by one on your camera

Did you know that repeatedly deleting images from an in-camera card while the card is still in your camera can actually shorten that card's life? It's true.

The rule is that the fewer times you add or remove data on your card, the better. So instead of selectively deleting files as you shoot, aim to erase all the images at once after uploading them to your computer. That way, you delete the files in a single cycle, not one at a time.

(Or better yet, use the Format function on your camera to wipe the card before each new photoshoot!)

5. Remove cards safely from your computer

It's tempting to connect a memory card to your computer, transfer the images, and then pull it out of the card reader.

Stuffed Lumaconi with Butternut Squash and Chestnuts Recipe

Clotilde · Chocolate & Zucchini

Buy Clotilde's latest book, *The French Market Cookbook* !

I will own up to it right then and there: I am an inveterate collector of pasta . Guilty as charged.

In fine food shops and Italian markets, I love to study the different shapes and imagine which will lend themselves to smooth sauces or chunky ones. I love their names (rooster's crests, radiators, little ears, thimbles), the traditional packaging, and the fact that, for just a few euros, I can treat myself to a package of something novel — not to mention the promise of an easy meal.

Before I had children, I had to rein in my purchases, as my kitchen cabinets overflowed faster than Maxence and I actually ate pasta. But with two young boys who would eat it at every meal if I let them — their dream breakfast is cold leftover pasta, a recessive trait for sure — I am free to buy whatever I please, knowing I will easily find a use for it.

And I recently fell hard for a package of lumaconi , those large snail-shaped pasta sold in big bulging packages that scream “Buy me, I’m special!”

Lumaconi are the kind of pasta whose life pursuit is to be stuffed with a sauce and gratinéed in the oven for an immensely satisfying vegetarian main dish, or a festive side to a roast bird. And as the holidays approach, I thought I would suggest a simple, seasonal sauce of roasted butternut squash and chestnuts .

You sprinkle the whole thing with cheese so it will brown nicely...

... and you squeeze lemon juice over the top just before serving. You end up with a golden and appetizing dish that boasts al dente pasta, a silky sauce that sticks to the ribbed sides of the lumaconi, little pockets of melty cheese with chestnut bits, and a top layer that is toasted and crunchy and irresistible. (Keep an eye on the little cousins who may be tempted to eat just the top.)

It's a recipe that is wowing but easy to make — the technique is straightforward, and many of the steps can be made in advance — and easy to live with — it's lovely at room temperature, and almost tastes better reheated.

Grating cheese with a microplane zester .

Have you tried this? Share your pics on Instagram!

Please tag your pictures with #cnzrecipes . I'll share my favorites!

Stuffed Lumaconi with Butternut and Chestnuts Recipe

Prep Time: 30 minutes

Cook Time: 40 minutes

Total Time: 1 hour

Serves 4.

1 small butternut squash or other firm-flesh winter squash, about 800 grams (1 3/4 pounds), seeds and fibers removed, flesh cubed (no need to peel if organic)

Olive oil

Fine sea salt

100 grams (3 1/2 ounces) cooked peeled chestnuts from a jar, chopped

1 small bunch flat leaf parsley , finely chopped

1 organic lemon

Coarse sea salt

250 grams (9 ounces) uncooked lumaconi (large snail-shaped pasta, such as these)

150 grams (1 1/2 cups) freshly grated cheese , such as Comté or Parmesan

First, prepare the filling.

Preheat the oven to 200°C (400°F).

On a rimmed baking sheet, arrange the butternut in a single layer. Drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle with 1 teaspoon salt. Mix with your hands to coat well.

Insert in the oven and roast for 30 minutes, until tender.

Process in a blender or food mill until smooth. This can be prepared up to a day ahead, or even frozen. Thaw before using.

Measure 500 grams (2 cups) of the butternut purée into a medium mixing bowl (reserve the remaining purée for another use). Add the chestnuts, parsley, and 1/2 teaspoon salt. Grate the zest of the lemon finely into the bowl and mix thoroughly.

Next, cook the pasta.

In a large saucepan, bring water to the boil with some coarse salt and a drizzle of olive oil. Add the lumaconi and boil until just shy of al dente, about 10 minutes.

Drain, return to the saucepan, drizzle with olive oil, and shake to coat so they won't stick to one another as you work.

Assemble and bake.

Grease a round 25-cm (10-inch) baking dish or cast-iron pan with olive oil.

Add the chestnuts, parsley, and 1/2 teaspoon salt.

clotilde

Cactus Jack Channels the “Gangster SpongeBob” Memes With Surprise Apparel Collaboration

Hypebeast

Cactus Jack has officially linked up with SpongeBob SquarePants for a collaborative apparel collection

The capsule features heavy-weight cotton garments with unique hand-sprayed treatments and distressed details

Fans can secure pieces ranging from graphic tees to hoodies through the official Travis Scott webstore

Travis Scott’s Cactus Jack has officially crossed over into Bikini Bottom, dropping a surprise SpongeBob SquarePants x Cactus Jack collection. The collaborative capsule merges the Houston native’s signature aesthetic with the ever-popular “Gangster SpongeBob” meme, resulting in a lineup of streetwear staples that channel spray paint art and graphics that reimagine the Bikini Bottom crew.

Anchoring the release is a series of heavyweight pieces, including the Fancy Life and Patrick Star hoodies alongside the Chum Bucket, SpongeBob x Mr. Krabs, Krabby Patty, and even Doodlebob T-shirts. The garments are elevated by co-branded artwork, utilizing screen print details on the front and back. Selected pieces receive a specialized freehand spray treatment, ensuring each individual item maintains a unique, one-of-one nature.

Also joining the delivery is the Rock Bottom Thermal Longsleeve, which focuses on Squidward, and a zip hoodie with Sponge-

Bob and Mr. Krabs showing off their wads of cash. Rounding out the collaboration are an adjustable low-profile Rock Bottom Hat, which features a distressed embroidered patch, and a duo of beanies for SpongeBob and Patrick. By blending familiar underwater motifs with Scott’s distinctively muted, earthy design language, the collection offers a fresh take on classic cartoon merchandising.

Check out the release above. The Cactus Jack x SpongeBob SquarePants collection is available now via Travis Scott’s official webstore .

Inside the -196 Konbini Backroom That Turned NYC Into a Tokyo After-Hours Scene

Hypebeast

What went down in New York City felt like a trans-portive cultural moment. On March 27, -196 — the Japanese-born vodka seltzer from Suntory Global Spirits — took over 169 Bowery and reimaged the Lower East Side as a fully immersive konbini experience, tapping into the global fascination with Japanese convenience store culture. For one night only, guests stepped into a space that mixed nightlife and pop culture, setting the tone for the kickoff to seltzer season.

The front of the space leaned heavily into Japanese c-store authenticity. Shelves were stocked with familiar Japanese convenience store staples like fruit sandos and onigiri, while fridges were packed with -196’s signature flavors — Lemon, Strawberry, Peach and Grapefruit — offering a first-hand introduction to the vodka seltzer’s fruit-forward profile. Hidden behind a discreet refrigerator door, the experience shifted gears entirely, transporting attendees from a casual konbini setting into a neon-lit Tokyo-inspired backroom that pulsed with contagious energy, all fueled by -196’s brand new tall boys in Lemon, Strawberry and Strawberry & Pineapple.

At the center of that transition was Rebecca Black , who brought her evolving DJ persona to the activation with a high-energy set that reflected her recent momentum — from festival stages to a viral Boiler Room appearance.

Her performance anchored the night, turning the space into a packed dance floor fueled by remixes and crowd energy. It was a fun mix of nostalgia, internet culture and club-ready sound that gave the activation its edge.

Beyond the spectacle, the event underscored a bigger play. Since launching nationwide in the U. S. last year and moving over 500,000 cases, -196 has been building its stateside presence by leaning into its Japanese roots — not just in flavor, but in experience. From its innovative Japanese Freeze, Crush, Infusion process, which gives the brand its real-fruit flavor, to immersive pop-ups like this, -196 has been leaning into their roots and bringing the flavor and hype of Japan to fans in the states. If this activation proved anything, it’s that -196 is highlighting a moment that feels distinctly global while landing right in the heart of downtown New York.

For more information visit minus196.com .

Also joining the delivery is the Rock Bottom Thermal Longsleeve, which focuses on Squidward, and a zip hoodie with SpongeBob and Mr.

Hypebeast

FREAK'S STORE Goes 'Back to the Future' For New Spring/Summer 2026 Collection

Hypebeast

FREAK'S STORE continues its popular bespoke movie collection with a new nostalgic apparel release

The short-sleeve tee features custom photo-print graphics honoring the legendary film *Back to the Future*

FREAK'S STORE is bringing cinematic nostalgia to its Spring/Summer 2026 lineup with the *Back to the Future* collection. Merging retro film culture with contemporary streetwear sizing, the Japanese retailer offers a fresh take on classic movie merchandise that feels both familiar and culturally relevant.

As part of its highly anticipated seasonal movie collection, FREAK'S STORE delivers a crewneck t-shirt that emphasizes everyday wearability. The garment features original, photo-style graphic prints drawn directly from the iconic sci-fi franchise. To balance the bold imagery, the front of the shirt utilizes a clean, minimal one-point design, ensuring the piece remains understated yet impactful.

Tailored for modern sensibilities, the t-shirt is cut with a deliberate "big silhouette." This relaxed, oversized fit drapes effortlessly, allowing for dynamic layering and diverse styling options suited for the warmer months. By blending comfortable proportions with celebrated pop-culture motifs, the brand successfully updates the traditional graphic tee format for today's wardrobes.

The FREAK'S STORE *Back to the Future* collection is slated to drop during the Spring/Summer 2026 season via FREAK'S STORE.

WIND AND SEA Celebrates 8 Years With An Anniversary Rework Collection

Hypebeast

Tokyo-based streetwear brand WIND AND SEA is celebrating its eighth anniversary with a special collection that reimagines its founding designs

The capsule features a mix of regular items in bright neon colorways alongside unique reworked pieces crafted from vintage garments

Standout items include the OG SEA and Script long-sleeve tees as well as exclusive one-of-one jackets and pants built from the past

Japanese label WIND AND SEA is officially launching the "WIND AND SEA 8th Anniversary Collection" to commemorate eight years of connecting culture and streetwear. Founded in Tokyo in 2018, the brand is revisiting its roots by updating its original designs through a contemporary lens.

The anniversary range is split into two distinct tiers: regular staples and exclusive rework pieces. The standard lineup breathes new life into the brand's 2018 beginnings, introducing the OG SEA L/S TEE and SCRIPT SEA L/S TEE in vibrant neon colorways, alongside the graphic-driven NUMBER EIGHT TEE. The iconic script logo makes its return to anchor these core items.

On the more experimental side, the "REWORK" capsule delivers one-of-a-kind garments constructed entirely from vintage clothing. Highlighting the "Built From The Past" ethos, this

tier includes the NUMBER EIGHT REWORK JACKET and PANT, both arriving in beige, as well as mixed-material tote bags and caps. Each reworked piece possesses a unique character, ensuring that no two items are exactly alike.

The regular items from the WIND AND SEA 8th Anniversary Collection drop in-store on Saturday, March 28, at the brand's Tokyo, Osaka, and Hankyu Umeda locations. An online lottery release follows on Sunday, March 29 via the official WIND AND SEA webstore, while the exclusive reworked pieces will be strictly limited to the WIND AND SEA TOKYO flagship.

Drink of the Week: Zumbador Tequila Blanco

Imbibe · Imbibe Magazine

As the tequila category has exploded in recent years and a dizzying number of brands have filled shelves, the process of finding a true artisanal tequila has become more confusing. But among this growing crowd are spirits that stand out for their heritage, process, and dedication to quality. Hailing from the highlands of Jesus Maria, Altos de Jalisco, Zumbador (which translates to hummingbird) is one such standout. Founded by fourth-generation agave grower Roberto López, Zumbador is a family-run distillery that produces blanco, reposado, and añejo tequila, and with spring and summer approaching, we are now reaching for their blanco.

The López family manages 1,000 acres of land with 1.5 million agaves planted in the Jaliscan highlands, where a perfect combination of altitude, soil, water, and climate allow for optimal growing conditions. Combine that with the family's selective harvesting and traditional production techniques of masonry oven cooking, tahona crushing, wood and steel fermenters, copper and steel pot distillation, and zero additives. The result is an outstanding spirit that represents an incredible value. "Zumbador is a tequila made to reflect what my family has been drinking for generations," says López. "Love, passion, work, and tradition in every drop."

Zumbador's blanco delivers a refined minerality and a subtle sweetness with cit-

rus and of floral notes that unfold gracefully. And while it's elegant enough to sip solo, it will shine in array of cocktails. Drink it in a traditional Batanga, a seasonal Margarita twist, or the Main Character recipe below. \$24.99, zumbadortequila.com

2 oz. Zumbador tequila
blanco 1/2 oz. agave nectar
1/2 oz fresh lime juice
1 cup fresh watermelon juice
Tools: shaker, strainer

Glass: Nick & Nora Garnish: watermelon ball

Shake all of the ingredients in shaker with ice. Strain into a chilled glass. Garnish.

The post Drink of the Week: Zumbador Tequila Blanco appeared first on Imbibe Magazine .

Nike Reimagines the Air Force 1 Low With Rugged Vibram Tooling

Hypebeast

Name: Nike Air Force 1 Low "Pencil Point," Nike Air Force 1 Low "Summit White," Nike Air Force 1 Low "Silt Red" Colorway: Pencil Point/Off Noir/Speed Yellow/Black, Silt Red/Light Violet Ore/Speed Yellow/Black, Summit White/Light Bone/Speed Yellow/Smoke Grey SKU: IH1943-100, IH1943-001, IH1943-600 MSRP: \$140 USD Release Date: Available now Where to Buy: Nike

Nike has officially unveiled the Nike Air Force 1 Low Vibram pack, bringing an aggressive, outdoor-ready edge to the legendary Bruce Kilgore design in the colorways of "Pencil Point," "Summit White," and a vibrant "Silt Red."

Preserving the unmistakable shape of the 1982 classic, the latest iteration introduces a massive shift underfoot. The traditional sole unit has been entirely swapped out for Vibram's signature high-performance rubber traction, complete with a rugged tread pattern built for supreme grip and durability. A recognizable yellow Vibram badge marks the heel, adding a subtle hit of contrast against the tonal sole.

Up top, the standard all-leather construction is replaced by ripstop-style grid textiles, giving the sneaker a technical and lightweight feel. Smooth leather swooshes and nylon tongues maintain a structural connection to the model's heritage, while tonal laces com-

plete the utilitarian design approach. The upcoming lineup includes a stealthy "Pencil Point" and Off Noir mix, a clean "Summit White" and Light Bone makeup, and a vibrant "Silt Red" offering accented with Light Violet Ore.

Easter Cocktails

Imbibe · Imbibe Magazine

Sure, you could whip up a batch of Mimosas or Bloody Marys , but why not liven up this year's Easter brunch celebration with something a little more unexpected? From frothy sours to fruity punches, try these spring-ready Easter cocktails.

Inspired by childhood memories of drinking Orange Julius smoothies.

Bee's Breakfast

Fresh berries, honey, and yogurt star in this delicious sipper.

Big in Japan

A gin cocktail that makes fresh raspberries the star.

Move over Mimosa—there's a new drink at the brunch table.

An unexpected star ingredient makes this Daiquiri perfect for springtime sipping.

French 75

One of our favorite crowd-pleasing Easter cocktails is this bubbly classic.

Chartreuse ups the herbaceousness of this gin cocktail from Portland, Maine's Hunt & Alpine Club .

Looking to capture the flavors of two of her favorite cocktails, Tampa bartender Amber Carregal created this Pimm's Gimlet.

Original instructions dictated that this New Orleans classic be shaken 12 minutes.

This spring-ready cocktail features a natural flavor pairing: savory carrot juice and spicy ginger.

Toast and Marmalade

Orange jam and bourbon mimic the tried-and-true combo.

A dollop of Greek yogurt is the key to this creamy cocktail.

The post Easter Cocktails appeared first on Imbibe Magazine .

ANALYSIS

30 Light and Bright Spring Dinner Recipes

Lindsay · Pinch of Yum

Spring is in the air – I can feel it! My weekly dinner menus are slowly turning over from soups and stews to salads and bowls filled with lots and lots of color.

This is the only list you need as we head into warmer, sunnier weather! * Some of my all-time favorite dinner recipes for spring are here – bright salads, easy sandwiches for a crowd, herby sauces and dressings, and lots of weeknight wonders (because spring is BUSY, too!).

Hoping you find a new dinner favorite!

Roasted Peanut Kale Crunch Salad

OOOH BABY, this salad is so good! Crunchy kale and cabbage, fresh herbs and fresno peppers, chopped peanuts, and a perfect roasted peanut vinaigrette that tucks into all the salad nooks and crannies.

34 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sun-Dried Tomato Focaccia Turkey Sandwich

Pillowy sun-dried tomato focaccia gets piled with pesto mayo, turkey, juicy tomato slices, and greens. This sandwich is a beauty and practically a lifestyle!

46 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Spring Roll Bowls with Sweet Garlic Lime Sauce

Spring Roll Bowls – basil, mint, rice noodles, fish sauce, brown sugar, lime juice, and whatever other protein and veggies you have on hand! Easy to make meatless!

110 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Salmon Tacos with Mango Corn Salsa

Super easy salmon tacos loaded with a mango, sweet corn, and cucumber salsa!

30 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Avocado Mojo Bowls with Sweet Potato and Chicken

We are living our best bowl life this week. Seasoned sweet potato wedges and chicken meatballs or rotisserie chicken all piled onto a plate with a little puddle of punchy green avocado mojo sauce. Yes, wow, repeat.

34 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Shredded cabbage and kale, shrimp, avocado, cilantro and chili-flavored peanuts, and the perfect sweet miso dressing.

35 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Cilantro Orange Chicken with Rice and Beans

This golden Cilantro Orange Chicken is so flavorful, crisped to golden brown perfection, and just very finger-licking good! Served with rice, beans, and a quick homemade pineapple salsa.

45 reviews / 4.6 average

[make this recipe](#)

Golden brown chicken meatballs cozied up next to fixings like cucumbers, shallots, kewpie mayo, mint, a bit of chili crisp, and some fresh cilantro to make the ultimate chicken sando!

45 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Liz's Bistro Salad

Crunchy, light, bright, and ultra-fresh. This French-inspired bistro salad is an absolute star as a side for nearly any dinner. Tender greens, fresh herbs, pickled onions, and a delicate vinaigrette on top.

20 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Chipotle Orange Shrimp with Cilantro Rice

Chipotle Orange Shrimp with Cilantro Rice! Tender shrimp in a sweet-meets-smoky cream sauce piled high on cilantro-speckled rice with a side of tangy cucumbers.

45 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta

These Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta are perfect for an easy SOS dinner! Store-bought meatballs, bell peppers, zucchini, harissa, and whipped feta all in one bowl. YUMMY!

39 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Feel-good Lunch Ideas

Heidi Swanson · 101 Cookbooks

Coming up with inspired lunch ideas takes some effort. One of the things I've been trying to be better about is lunches on-the-go. Often times, let's be honest, it's re-marketing leftovers. Too often, if we're not going to be home for the day, we just wing it. And I'm nearly always sorry we didn't make the effort to pack a good lunch. This is especially true if we're on some sort of trip, towing the Airstream . Because on those days parking dictates where you're lunching. And just thinking about it is making me cringe. So yeah, we're trying to do better over here and I thought I'd share some recent wins.

Lunch Ideas #1

These lunch boxes (above) came together pretty quickly. Nearly everything was a leftover, or component of a previous meal. To pull it together I peeled and chile-dusted the hard boiled eggs , sliced the avocado and sliced the mandarin.

1. Spicy Sesame Coleslaw : You've seen it before, you'll see it again. Lol. It's my favorite coleslaw , and I'll basically tuck in anywhere. Feathery green and red cabbages along with carrots, apples, and scallions tossed with a spicy, creamy sesame dressing.
2. Pickled Cauliflower : The pop of color you need in your lunch. This quick pickled cauliflower delivers a good amount of tang and crunch in the midst of less structured components. I make mine with chiles, mustard seeds and slivered onion, but you can play around.
3. Chile-dusted Hard-boiled Egg: Here's how to make these. Combine equal parts chile powder and MDH chana masala powder in a small bowl. I like to use this Kashmiri chillie powder , but use what you have (and like). Hard boil eggs , peel them, rinse, dab each egg a bit on a clean towel to take off excess water, then roll them around in the spice mixture until completely covered. Slice and serve, or pack into lunch.
4. Turmeric-Scallion Tofu Spread : This is actually leftover wonton filling from my last round of wonton soup . But it's also great as a lettuce wrap filling, cracker and sandwich spread, and on its own. Here, I nestle it into a stack of 2-3 little gem leaves. Get the recipe – it's the first part of the recipe on this page, minus the wrappers.
5. Red-spiced Edamame : I'll write this up as its own recipe soon, it's a homemade spice blend made by crushing Kashmiri chillies, smoked paprika, brown sugar, sesame, dried onion flakes, salt, and a kiss of cardamom together. Sprinkle generously. There are a lot of other spice blend ideas in the Spice / Herb / Flower / Zest PDF that members get. Just about any of those are great here. Experiment!

6. Pepita & Curry Leaf Tadka : I've definitely over-stripped my young curry tree making this lately. Toast a cup of pepitas and set aside. Heat 2 tablespoons of oil in a small saucepan over medium-high heat, stir in 50-ish fresh curry leaves. Continue to stir and when the leaves begin to crisp up add 2 teaspoons black mustard seeds. Keep stirring and when the seeds have toasted a bit and stopped popping, add 1/2 teaspoon chile powder. Pour this over your pepitas, toss well, and salt to taste. good on everything, Including the soba in the next lunch.

Also: purple rice, sliced avocado, mandarin wedge, nutritional yeast kale chips

Lunch Ideas #2

The one component of the lunch boxes (above) that wasn't made ahead of time, was the soba noodles. I boiled them, and ran them under cold water just before packing up.

- 6+. Soba with Pepita & Curry Leaf Tadka : The same pepitas as above (lunch ideas #1), this time tangled with cold soba.

Toss the kale with olive oil and scrunch it all up with your hands, be sure it's all coated.

Heidi Swanson

7. Vegan Tamagoyaki : This is a vegan version of tamagoyaki, the much-loved Japanese rolled omelette. I like to make chickpea-tofu version, and this one is lined with nori and seasoned with scallions and herbs. They're fantastic lunchbox heroes because you can make and roll them ahead of time. They'll keep for a few day so you can slice and go.
8. Blistered Artichoke Hearts : Leftovers from dinner the previous night. I cooked these from frozen. So easy, so good. I wrote a long post about how to cook artichokes – both fresh and frozen. So, if you love artichokes, but think they're too much work, read this. Same goes if you think the frozen ones are going to be bad. They aren't and they're great in scenarios like this one, quick pastas, casseroles, etc.
9. Fava Beans Tossed with Citrus Olive Oil : These are fava beans that have been shelled, boiled for a flash, shelled again, and then splashed with a bit of lemon olive oil, and tossed with a pinch of salt. From previous dinner. I do the same with edamame, but favas are in season and I they're worth all the shelling and peeling drama.
10. Kale Chips : Some extra crushed kale chips tossed with the remaining pepitas. My method for epic kale chips is this: buy curly kale, make sure it's dry if you recently washed it. Toss the kale with olive oil and scrunch it all up with your hands, be sure it's all coated. Toss with a lot of nutritional yeast, get a good coating going. Season with salt and bake at until the chips at the edges start browning. Toss well. Continue to bake until crisp, but

Radisson Resort and Spa Lonavala Celebrates the Remaining Natural Beauty of India's Popular Sahyadris Region

Adrian Madlener · Design Milk Architecture

Just a two hour's drive from the ever-bustling and expanding sprawl of Mumbai—India's second city—the Sahyadris Hills unfold with a cooler and less humid climate. For decades now, the region—also noted for its ancient forts and Buddhist caves—has been a popular weekend destination for city-dwellers in search of respite but, like the dense and crowded urban cores they're escaping, it has also succumbed to rampant and unregulated development. Ironically, much of the natural beauty here has fallen victim to its fame. Such is the unfortunate fate of many sought-after resort areas in favorable proximity to a major city or conurbation.

Looking to maintain what is left of the verdant landscape and make it available to guests in a more responsible way is the recently completed Radisson Resort and Spa Lonavala .

Replete with several distinctive restaurants, events venues, and other premium amenities, the retreat embeds into its 'hill station' surroundings through its innovative architectural massing, materiality, and the implementation of climate-specific strategies inspired by the local architectural vernacular. The decidedly Brutalist yet emphatically site-responsive complex is a far cry from the antiseptic chain hotels that often feel out-of-place and inauthentic.

"The sense of open space of connecting to nature is contested by the building forms that emerge through the prescribed structural codes and densities," says Kamal Malik, the founder the eponymously named, Mumbai-based firm responsible for the hotel's design "The architecture emerges from the site, topography, from the region's material history—black basalt and wood—and adapts to both flexible and fixed—public and private—programs."

Malik Architecture's comprehensive intervention incorporates reinterpreted architectural archetypes from the region: courtyards, verandahs, deep-shading, thick walls, and cross-ventilation. The main focus however is the surrounding nature. Monumental volumes give way to soaring apertures visible for numerous semi-indoor and semi-outdoor vantage points. All together, the scheme accommodates optimal natural ventilation, safeguards against heavy rain during Monsoon season, and protects against harsh sun rays.

Suites come with adjoining patios enclosed by operable slatted shading walls. The guest rooms occupy abstract-form buildings hovering above the ground. Shafts of natural light slice across these angular volumes and illuminate atriums that appear between.

"The feeling of a multi-storey building has been avoided by developing the ground as organic, free form public spaces with split level topographical connections," Malik adds. "Extant forms—bastions and Large masonry walls—stepped

courts, otherwise known as kunds—animate the built landscape."

A rich earth tone palette, defined by many of the same substrate materials as the exterior, makes its way into the interiors but doesn't overpower as the main attraction remains the carefully framed natural setting outside. There's no superfluous decoration, just a sober deployment of ornamentation hinting at the local Maratha culture. Spacious guest rooms and suites are pared back with a calming modernist aesthetic only interrupted by fluted tambour-pattern feature walls and traditional carpets denoting the placement of beds.

Alongside numerous sports facilities including everything from a fully-equipped fitness center and steam room to archery and badminton fields, Radisson Resort and Spa Lonavala's dining options include the quintessential Indian style Hirkani—with stations that allow guest to watch their food being prepared—and a series of pop-up haunts. Malhari is the go-to cocktail bar. The historic Tungarli Village situates right out the resort.

What: Radisson Resort and Spa Lonavala

Where: Lonavala, India

How much: Rooms starting at \$137

Design draws: A site responsible destination embedded within the popular getaway Sahyadris region of western India with materiality, proportions, cuisine, and activities programmed in honor of the verdant nature in the immediate surroundings.

Go virtually on vacation with more design destinations right here .

Photography courtesy of Radisson Resort and Spa.

Inside Piaule's Design-Driven Catskills Escape With Design Within Reach

Hayley Arsenault · Design Milk Architecture

Across fifty acres of forest in upstate New York, Piaule sits as a small constellation of modernist structures connected by footpaths neatly tucked into a west-facing rise, which overlooks the Catskill Mountains. The landscape hotel first debuted in 2021 with two dozen cedar-clad guest cabins on stilts, alongside a communal space, a restaurant focused on locally sourced fare, a spa and wellness facility a short walk away, and a braided network of trails threading the site.

For founders Nolan McHugh and Trevor Briggs, who conceived Piaule after establishing a homeware line of the same name, design decisions have been guided by modern precedents and deference to the natural surroundings. This focus now carries into a new collaboration with Design Within Reach (DWR), marked by refreshed furnishings across shared spaces, cabins, and the newly completed Oak House. From dining tables set with Arne Jacobsen's Series 7 chairs to fireplaces framed by John Pawson's low-slung Drift sofa, canonical works of modern design appear alongside new classics and Piaule original furnishings, shaping the interiors and their relationship to the landscape beyond.

The collaboration builds on shared references established over time. From the earliest stages of Piaule, McHugh and Briggs had been drawing from DWR's portfolio, incorporating pieces that resonated with the property's architectural restraint and material sensibility. "We have a shared belief in the role of modern design as both educational and experiential," says Debbie Propst, President of Global Retail at MillerKnoll.

"Piaule's vision for how architecture, interiors, and nature intersect strongly aligns with DWR's long-standing commitment to inspiring people through well-designed spaces." As DWR's assortment expanded to encompass a broader spectrum of works, the collaboration evolved in step. Selections emerged through sustained dialogue, with close attention to material and proportion.

Set apart from Piaule's main cluster of cabins, the Oak House occupies a twenty-acre parcel uphill from the Main House. Configured as a three-bedroom residence, it is oriented to the landscape on all sides, allowing light, weather, and sound to register continuously inside. Views shift from room to room, opening onto meadow and mountain outlooks, pine groves, and stands of mature oak and hickory. Each vantage registers differently within the interior space.

The furnishings follow suit, with most crafted in solid wood and positioned in direct relation to the landscape. "Placing these pieces in this context lends them an even greater beauty and gravity and gives the guest a greater appreciation for the craft of each piece," says McHugh. "The source material, decades-old and standing 60-plus feet tall, is visible in all its glory just outside." Seating from Herman Miller and Fritz Hansen is joined by tables and storage from USM

and Cassina, alongside furnishings developed in-house by Piaule.

Lighting by Vaarnii brings a soft, diffuse presence to the interiors and continues onto the outdoor deck, where dining and seating frame the fire pit and views beyond. "Each room has its own door to the deck so that everyone can control their own interactions between indoor and outdoor—leaving the door open to let in the breeze, wandering out to one of the chairs with a cup of coffee, or gazing out at the stars while lying comfortably in bed," McHugh adds.

Piaule's Double Cabins and 3,200-square-foot Main House exhibit the same modernist sensibility. For the hotel's signature two-bedroom accommodations, which are linked by a shared living room, furnishings were selected from DWR's assortment with an emphasis on design that heightens the spaces without asserting itself against the site. "Taking inspiration from our surroundings, there is an entire palette of materials that ensure a luxurious experience for guests but does not distract from the landscape outside," says Briggs.

Updates to the main house build on references already present across the property. Oak Tabouret stools designed by Charlotte Perriand for Cassina echo the three-legged form of traditional Alpine milking stools, a vernacular object Piaule has long incorporated throughout the hotel. "When we are so closely linked to both the source material and the finished product, a deeper gratitude for those earthly gifts arises," says McHugh.

The collaboration between Piaule and DWR is underpinned by modern precedents and material sources grounded in the conditions of the site itself. Furnishings are placed in direct relation to their surroundings, allowing the landscape to remain a constant presence that evolves with the interiors over time.

To learn more about the collaborating bodies, visit piaule.com and dwr.com.

Photography courtesy of Piaule Catskill.

SARATOGA FAMILY, The Ultimate Holiday Gift for Your Family: A VACATION!!

Anne Gordon · Live Life Travel

The Ultimate Holiday Gift for Your Family: A VACATION!!

It may be cliché, but also very true, the best gift that you can give your family (especially your children) is the gift of time. And what better way than traveling the world as a family.

4 TIPS FOR PLANNING ANY TYPE OF FAMILY TRAVEL

1) PLAN AHEAD – It's never too early to start planning

Tip: Airfare goes on sale 11 months in advance; We like the Hopper APP to track airfare prices

2) DON'T WAIT – Start them young; they grow up way too fast

3) ENGAGE – Let them be part of the decision; Inclusive family decisions always make every trip much more successful.

4) EDUCATE – Don't tell the kids, but traveling the world is a totally super fun way to learn all of that "stuff" that they teach you in school.

Tip: The SSCD kids learn about Ancient Rome, Greece, China, India and Egypt in the 6th Grade, we recommend taking them to these magnificent destinations after the 6th Grade.

We recommend the Cape Town – Sabi Sands – Victoria Falls combo if you want to do it right.

Anne Gordon

LIVE LIFE TRAVEL'S TOP PICKS FOR FAMILY TRAVEL

BEACHES TURKS AND CAICOS – To us, this is comparable to what Disney World is to the rest of American children (but way better!); Contact us to receive your \$250 spa credit

Tip: We recommend booking 1-2 years in advance for this property (for high season weeks); there are 2 other Beaches located in Jamaica (Negril and Ocho Rios); we love them all

ITALY – Ancient Rome is really something spectacular, especially after learning about it in 6th grade, we think that Italy is a trip that the entire family can enjoy; We also highly suggest heading down to Sicily, a hidden gem

AFRICAN SAFARI – A must for every family; truly a once in a lifetime experience. We recommend the Cape Town – Sabi Sands – Victoria Falls combo if you want to do it right.

HAWAII – A favorite destination for families over the Holiday Break and for good reason! We love the Grand Wailea in Maui and The Four Seasons Hualalai on The Big Island.

Experience two very different landscapes as to what Hawaii has to offer

ALASKA – Experience nature up close and personal with Lindblad Expeditions on the National Geographic expedition ships that have custom programs just for kids

FOUR SEASONS RESORTS – In general, you just cannot go wrong, and we love them. Our top family choices are Nevis, Costa Rica, Anguilla, Chiang Mai and Langkawi.

OUR #1 FAMILY TRAVEL RECOMMENDATION: GLOBAL CITIZENS WANTED

ME to WE – A new travel partner to our Virtuoso family, this company is one of our very favorites. We would encourage you all to please check out their video on our Facebook and Instagram pages. If you want to make a difference in the world, if you want to make an impact with your children, if you want to create lifelong memories and a feeling that will never fade away, then ME to WE is what you are looking for. Travel itineraries currently include Ecuador, Kenya and India. Contact us to learn more!

52% of Americans do not take all their PAID vacation time.

Please do not become or stay part of this statistic— Vacations are healthy, not only for you physically and mentally, but emotionally for your family, especially for kids. Life is short, make the most of it!

The post SARATOGA FAMILY, The Ultimate Holiday Gift for Your Family: A VACATION!! appeared first on Live Life Travel .

11 Best Lenses for Landscape Photography (in 2025)

Jeremy Flint · Digital Photography School

The post 11 Best Lenses for Landscape Photography (in 2025) appeared first on Digital Photography School . It was authored by Jeremy Flint .

Have any lenses been launched that you think have overtaken the ones in this list? Are there any in this list that should still be at the top of the list?

What do you have that you think is better? (Otherwise you wouldn't have it, would you!)

I think, for me, in terms of "all-rounder" the Tamron 35-150 has found a permanent spot in my backpack.

This article was updated on Tuesday the 3rd of March, 2026...

No matter your level of experience, if you want to capture beautiful landscape photos, you need to choose your lens carefully. After all, the lens heavily influences the quality of your image; pick a good lens, and you have the potential for crisp, clear, beautifully detailed results. But get the lens wrong, and you may find that your images are consistently unsatisfying.

But choosing the right lens for landscape photography can be tough. There are dozens – even hundreds – of options, ranging from budget kit zooms to \$3000+ ultra-wide glass, each with its own benefits (and drawbacks).

Fortunately, as a professional landscape photographer, I've spent years working with different lens models. I know how to pick the perfect starter lens, and I know how to find lenses that'll satisfy the most experienced professionals. That's why I've written this article, which takes you through all the best landscape photography lenses you can buy today – including options for mirrorless and DSLR shooters, choices for Canon, Nikon, Sony, and Fujifilm shooters, and picks at every price point.

So without further ado, here are my top landscape lens recommendations, starting with my number one choice:

1. Sony FE 12-24mm f/2.8 GM

If you're an experienced photographer seeking the absolute best landscape lens on the market – no matter the cost – then the Sony 12-24mm f/2.8 GM is the model to buy.

It has everything that you could want in a landscape lens, including ridiculously sharp optics that pair beautifully with the high-resolution sensors of the a7R series, incredible build quality that can handle all sorts of weather scenarios, and a surprisingly lightweight body. The lens also boasts an f/2.8 maximum aperture that's perfect for serious astrophotography (and it also comes in handy if you're looking to add some artistic background blur to your landscape shots).

Of course, there's also a stunning 12mm focal length on the wide end, so ultra-wide shooters can capture scenes of all types with a uniquely expansive perspective, while on the longer end, the 24mm perspective will give you a more conventional wide-angle field of view. Unfortunately, the 12-24mm f/2.8 GM is extremely expensive (at the time of writing, it costs nearly \$3000), but if you're a professional or you have the cash to spare, you won't be disappointed.

2. Canon EF 16-35mm f/4L IS USM

If you use Canon full-frame DSLRs – or even Canon mirrorless models – then the 16-35mm f/4L IS USM is an excellent choice. It carries the prestigious L-series label and boasts a nice range of focal lengths as well as very sharp image quality.

There is an f/2.8 version of this lens, but the f/4 version gives equally stunning results and comes with a cheaper price tag. (The main reason you'd want to consider the f/2.8 version for landscape photography is if you like to capture the night sky; in such scenarios, an ultra-wide maximum aperture will help you freeze the motion of the stars.)

The 16-35mm f/4L is a fast and dynamic model with an ultrasonic focus system and a minimum focusing distance of 11 inches (0.28 meters), so it's perfect for capturing sweeping vistas that feature close foreground subjects. Plus, the 4-stops of image stabilization and great in-built weather sealing allow you to work handheld in all types of light and weather.

The 16-35mm f/4L is a reasonably priced option for enthusiasts (and is positively cheap compared to other pro-level lenses on this list), though beginners may wish to consider a more budget-friendly model like the 24-105mm f/4L (which is elsewhere on this list!). If you're a budding Canon landscape shooter – or even a professional – hoping to create stunning images of expansive scenes, then this is one of the best landscape lenses on the market in 2024.

Note: The 16-35mm f/4L is designed for full-frame Canon DSLRs, though you can also use it with any of Canon's RF-mount mirrorless cameras with the purchase of the Canon EF-EOS R adapter. The adapter is essentially flawless, though if you're a Canon mirrorless user and you prefer to use RF-mount lenses, take a look at the RF 15-35mm f/2.8L IS USM below.

3. Nikon Z 14-30mm f/4 S

The Nikon Z 14-30mm f/4 lens was Nikon's first ultra-wide-angle zoom for Z-mount cameras, and it remains one of the best lenses for Nikon full-frame mirrorless cameras in 2024, especially for professionals in search of that ultra-wide perspective. It's also surprisingly affordable for a Z-mount lens, and while I wouldn't recommend it to complete beginners, it should certainly meet the budgetary needs of enthusiasts and professionals.

Everything Coming to HBO Max in April 2026

Hypebeast

HBO Max has shared its programming list for April 2026

Leading the charge is the return of Euphoria alongside Zendaya, Hunter Schafer, and more

Also joining the streamer are Marty Supreme and Christy

With March coming to an end, HBO Max has unveiled its slate of new programming for April 2026.

Next month's list is led by the highly anticipated return of the Zendaya -led Euphoria , with season three making its premiere over three years after its predecessor. Subscribers can also catch the fifth and final season of Hacks, as well as the streaming premieres of A24 and Timothée Chalamet's Marty Supreme , Alien: Romulus and Sydney Sweeney 's Christy .

Check out the full list below.

TITLES COMING TO HBO MAX IN APRIL *This list may not be comprehensive and is subject to change

April 1

A Big Hand for a Little Lady

Abbott and Costello Meet Captain Kidd

Alien vs. Predator: Extended Cut

Alien 3

Alien 3: The Assembly Cut

Alien Resurrection: Special Edition

Alien vs. Predator: Requiem: Extended Cut

Alien: Director's Cut

Aliens vs. Predator: Requiem

Aliens: Director's Cut

Abbott and Costello In Hollywood

AVP: Alien vs. Predator

Blood on the Moon

Cabin in the Sky

Deeply, Season 1

Deeply, Season 2

Deeply, Season 3

Evil Lives Here: My Child the Killer, Season 1 (ID)

Gunsmoke in Tucson

Inu-Oh

Man From the Black Hills

Maze Runner: The Death Cure

Mortal Kombat Legends: Battle of the Realms

Mortal Kombat Legends: Cage Match

Mortal Kombat Legends: Scorpion's Revenge

Mortal Kombat Legends: Snow Blind

Out of the Past

Rachel and the Stranger

Renovation Aloha, Season 3 (HGTV)

Shoot-Out at Medicine Bend

Tall in the Saddle

The Boy and the Beast

The Flame and the Arrow

The Hole in the Ground

The Left-Handed Gun

The Man Behind the Gun

The Man with a Cloak

The Mummy (1999)

The Mummy: Tomb of the Dragon Emperor

The St. Louis Kid

They Died with Their Boots On

Thunder Over the Plains

Welcome to Plathville, Season 8 (TLC)

Westward the Women

April 2 Body Bizarre, Season 8 (TLC) Expedition Files, Season 4 (Discovery)

April 3 Alien: Romulus Dream Stage, Season 1

April 4 Game Night

April 5 Teen Titans Go!, Season 9G (Cartoon Network)

April 7 Tropic Like It's Hot, Season 1 (HGTV)

April 9 Hacks, Season 5 (Max Original) The World's Tallest

Bianca Censori Directs the Surreal Music Video for Ye and Travis Scott's "FATHER"

Hypebeast

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Bianca Censori has officially unveiled her self-directed music video for Ye and Travis Scott's collaborative track "FATHER"

The visual project is presented as a short film shot in a single continuous take without any cuts

The cinematic release arrives alongside the drop of Ye's brand-new studio album BULLY

Bianca Censori has officially unveiled her self-directed music video for "FATHER," a collaborative track from Ye and Travis Scott. Premiering alongside the release of Ye's new album BULLY, the buzzed-about visual project takes the form of a short film set within a surreal dream that exists entirely outside of conventional time and space.

Stepping behind the camera, Censori approaches the music video format as a direct extension of her conceptual work in spatial design and visual art. The ambitious film is captured in a single continuous shot with zero cuts, constructing a deep psychological landscape where ritual, memory, and fantasy seamlessly converge. Rather than depicting a literal religious setting, the director transforms a church into a symbolic interior realm characterized by suspended architecture and characters moving with ceremonial precision.

By blending performance art, architectural minimalism, and cinematic abstraction, the immersive environment explores heavy themes of collective belief, spectacle, and transformation. Moments of profound stillness are contrasted with chaos to create an atmosphere of heightened emotional intensity. The self-directed project marks a significant continuation of Censori's expanding repertoire, further positioning her as a multidisciplinary talent working at the intersection of contemporary art, performance, and film.

The music video for "FATHER" is available to watch online alongside the release of Ye's album BULLY.

Read more at Hypebeast

Steel House in Denver Embraces Industrial Elements and Nature

Anna Zappia · Design Milk Architecture

Corporate environments often capture the urban spirit of their locales but lack warmth and a connection to nature. For Steel House, a new commercial development in Denver, Colorado, that boasts ground-floor retail and seven stories of office space, Morris Adjmi Architects created a hub with machine-made styling that also celebrates the Mile High City's natural surroundings.

Located in the River North (RiNo) Arts District, a sector favored by creatives, the building's form and detailing references the warehouse typologies that once defined the area. "We were drawing on a mixture of the Denver lifestyle and the neighborhood's past, embracing its industrial character and nature at the same time," says Morris Adjmi, founder and principal of his eponymous firm.

The primary facade is clad in C-channel metal panels in charcoal and silver tones, in an expression of verticality and rhythm. A tower at the southwest corner marks the building's entrance. This steel-framed structure serves as a striking sculptural element and a visual anchor, both from the street and the adjacent rail corridor.

Interiors reflect the same language as the architecture, but with added warmth via materials and biophilic elements. Tenants and visitors are welcomed into the double-height lobby that was designed as a reception area

and gathering space. A cleft-stone front desk and textured brick flooring are reminiscent of a hospital setting. The open office floors allow occupants to tailor their environments for maximum flexibility.

The wellness-focused lifestyle of the city's residents is key, with 10,000-square-feet of amenities on offer. An indoor sports court, climbing wall, and yoga studio are ideal for individuals who want to stay active during the day. Commuters can also store their cycles in a bike room with repair stations.

A seamless flow from interior to exterior invites connection with people and nature. On the sixth floor, a 13,000-square-foot communal terrace functions as an outdoor living room—complete with views of downtown and the Rocky Mountains. Lounge areas, grills, and dining spaces are utilized for a range of events, from casual lunches to evening parties.

Steel House is a place that defies typical notions of these types of buildings by revealing character, not fabricating it. "A lot of times an industrial aesthetic feels contrived, but here, because of the way the building was sculpted, and these indoor and outdoor spaces meld, it feels like a real artifact—a good place to live and work—as opposed to something that was just layered on top of it," Adjmi notes.

To see learn more about Steel house, or see other works by the architect, visit ma.com.

Nike Prepares The Air Force 1 Low “Heat Map” For Summer

Hypebeast

Name: Nike Air Force 1 Low “Heat Map” Colorway: Black/Racer Blue SKU: IB6834-001 MSRP: \$130 USD Release Date: Summer 2026

Nike is turning up the temperature on its iconic Bruce Kilgore design with the upcoming release of the Nike Air Force 1 Low “Heat Map.” Arriving just in time for the warmer months, this latest iteration reimagines the streetwear staple with an aura-like, thermographic aesthetic.

The sneaker starts with a premium soft black leather base that dramatically transitions on the lower half of the side panels. This section boasts a misty heat map style, blending shades of blue, yellow, red, and orange just below the signature Swoosh and extending toward the midsole.

Additional detailing elevates the thematic approach, with a vibrant “Racer Blue” hitting the laces and sockliner for a bold contrast against the dark upper. The design is rounded out by a unique blue star lace dubrae positioned above the vamp, adding a final specialized touch to the classic model.

BRIEFS

Christopher Bonanos, Curbed: In the Chrysler Building’s 96 years of occupancy, exactly two people have managed to pull off the children’s-book fantasy of living there. (Officially, or at least semi.) They couldn’t have been more different; one was an artist, the other a corporate titan. In the mind’s eye, it’s a Fred Astaire... [More »](#)

Nik Sharma, Serious Eats: Sweet and tender roasted beets, carrots, and onions, tossed with a zippy lime dressing and topped with crunchy, golden shallots. [Get Recipe!](#)

The Investor, Monevator:

R emember my natural yield model portfolio that I kicked off in May last year? I know that many of you do, because you keep emailing me about it!

This article can be read by selected Monevator members. Please see our membership plans and consider joining! Already a member? [Sign in here](#) .

The post [The natural yield model portfolio wheels are turning](#) [Members] appeared first on [Monevator](#) .

Matthew Sedacca, Curbed: David Drumgold’s room in what was until recently the Jane Hotel is small and showing its age. A full-size bed in the 9-by-13-foot space juts out against a gray armchair that is buried under a mountain of clothing waiting to be sent to the dry cleaner. The door paint is chipping, revealing the “as... [More »](#)

Katie Leaird, Serious Eats: Orecchiette with olive oil, garlic, chiles, anchovies, bitter greens, and toasted breadcrumbs. Straight from the heel of Italy. [Get Recipe!](#)

Jerry Saltz, Curbed: On the occasion of her 2016 retrospective at the New Museum, Nicole Eisenman grabbed me by the shoulders and pleaded, “Get me out of here!” One didn’t look at art in the old, claustrophobic version of the building; one endured it. Now, the snazzy stacked boxes on Bowery [More »](#)

Justin Davidson, Curbed: In New York, the fresh ripens into the antique at formidable speed. Sanaa’s New Museum opened on Bowery in 2007, and under a decade later, it already needed more space. After multiple delays and a two-year closure, the museum is reo... [More »](#)

Bigphoto, One Big Photo: Did you know that approximately 41% — or around four of 10 — of the 50 million or so rental housing units in the U. S. are owned by individual investor landlords? Owning real estate can be a great investment. You’ll benefit as the property appreciates in value over time, and you can [...]

Bigphoto, One Big Photo: Personalized photo gifts are always a great idea for your loved ones, but you don’t want to go with something plain. Sure, printing photos and making a photo album can be a nice gift, but there are other options that are far more impressive. 1. A custom canvas print It’s always nice [...]

Adriane Quinlan, Curbed: The house with the blue door on Wyckoff Street, in Boerum Hill, got more mail than the neighbors’ homes. Envelopes heavy with manuscripts arrived at the ground-floor entrance, piling up on the dining table by the window, which doubled as a slush pile for the independent poetry press [More »](#)

Christopher Bonanos, Curbed: By this afternoon, the main MTA app on your phone will likely have updated, and not a moment too soon. Launched in 2024 and built by an outside contractor, the old app — and I refer here to the principal one, simply called ... [More »](#)

Sunny Lee, Serious Eats: Basque cheesecake boasts a deeply caramelized top and bottom, with a creamy center thanks to a high-temperature bake. No crust required. [Get Recipe!](#)

Christopher Bonanos, Curbed: I happened to be 1,800 miles from New York when the prospect of parking fees as budget-gap closer entered the chat, and I could very nearly hear the howling from there. The New York Post , as is its custom, [More »](#)

Bigphoto, One Big Photo: New and old marketers alike recognize the phrase “content is king,” but it’s naive to suggest that “content” means the same thing it used to, back when the phrase initially rose to prominence. Content is still king, for the most part, but it is evolving. How is it evolving and how should your [...]

Bigphoto, One Big Photo: Nobody wants to watch their parents get older and start to struggle in the physical world, but it’s an unavoidable fact of life. At some point, your parents will begin to have a hard time with things. For example, they might lose some strength, have trouble walking, or lose some of their mental faculties. When [...]

The Monitor

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